The Are We There Yet Kit

The Great American Road Trip: Family Vacations, Station Wagons & Roadside Adventures

INSIDE THIS KIT

- Conversation Cards
- Word Link Game
- Musical Memory
- Trivia Time
- BINGO
- *Bonus:* Visual Spark Cards

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Why This Kit Works For You & Your Residents

Designed for real Activity Directors who need meaningful engagement without hours of prep.

Recognition Over Recall

Residents are not put on the spot to “remember.” Instead, familiar themes, visuals, and prompts gently spark recognition, allowing participation without pressure.

Dignified & Adult-Centric

Every activity is designed for adults — not childish or overly simplified. The tone, topics, and visuals respect life experience and identity.

Multi-Sensory Engagement

This kit blends conversation, visuals, music, and group interaction to engage different cognitive pathways. Residents can participate in the way that feels most natural to them.

Adaptable for All Abilities

Activities can be used 1:1, in small groups, or larger settings. You can scale up or down depending on cognitive level, energy, and time available.

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How to Run This Session

No prep. No guesswork. Just follow the flow.

YOUR DONE-FOR-YOU SESSION FLOW · 45–60 MINUTES

1

WARM UP

Conversation Cards

5–10 minutes

Gently open the session with familiar, low-pressure prompts. Encourages comfort, participation, and initial connection.

2

ENGAGE

Visual Spark Cards

10–15 minutes

Use imagery to trigger recognition, storytelling, and memory. Ideal for residents who respond better to visuals than direct questions.

3

CONNECT

BINGO or Trivia

15–20 minutes

Bring energy into the room with structured group interaction. Encourages laughter, participation, and shared experiences.

4

EMOTIONAL CLOSE

Musical Memory

10 minutes

End the session with music-based prompts or familiar songs. Creates emotional connection, calm, and a meaningful finish.

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What's Included in Your Kit

Everything you need to run multiple engaging sessions — without creating content from scratch.

6 ACTIVITIES · MULTIPLE SESSIONS · ZERO PREP

Conversation Cards
Thoughtfully written prompts that spark stories and memories. Works in group and one-on-one settings.

Visual Spark Cards
Image-based prompts that trigger recognition and emotional recall. Ideal for residents who respond better to visuals.

Trivia Game
Curated questions based on familiar themes and shared cultural experiences. Encourages participation, not frustration.

Word Link Game
Engaging word association activity that stimulates cognition in a low-pressure way. Works across all ability levels.

BINGO Activity
A familiar game adapted with meaningful, recognizable themes. Encourages group interaction and energy.

Musical Memory
Song and lyric-based activities that tap into emotional memory. Perfect for connection and ending on a high note.

TOTAL VALUE

Multiple activities. Multiple sessions. Use this kit again and again without repeating the same experience.

"Designed to save you hours of planning — while delivering meaningful, dignified engagement."

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SECTION 1

CONVERSATION CARDS

CONVERSATION STARTERS — CUT, LAMINATE & ENJOY

Packing the Car

A-1

"How did your family pack the car for a big trip? Was it an art form or a free-for-all? Who was in charge of making everything fit?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

A-2

"What was the one thing you absolutely had to bring along — a pillow, a favorite book, a stuffed animal, a transistor radio? What made the trip feel like it had officially started?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

A-3

"Did your family leave at the crack of dawn to 'beat the traffic,' or was getting out the door its own adventure? What was the mood in those first few miles?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Life in the Back Seat

B-1

“Who sat where in the car? Was there a battle for the window seat, or did everyone have their assigned spot? What happened when someone crossed the invisible line?”

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

B-2

“How did you pass the time on long stretches? License plate games, 'I Spy,' counting cows, singing songs? What was your go-to way to survive the miles?”

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

B-3

“Did anyone in your family get carsick? Was there a particular winding road or a hot afternoon that everyone remembers for the wrong reason?”

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Roadside Stops & Pit Stops

C-1

"Do you remember stopping at a roadside diner or lunch counter along the way? What did you order, and what did the place look like?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

C-2

"Did your family ever stop at a quirky roadside attraction — a giant ball of twine, a mystery spot, a dinosaur statue? What was the strangest thing you pulled over for?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

C-3

"Gas station stops were their own little event. Do you remember the attendant filling the tank and washing the windshield? Did you get a cold bottle of soda from the machine?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

Where We Stayed

D-1

"Did your family stay at motor courts, motels, campgrounds, or a relative's house? What do you remember about where you slept on the road?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

D-2

"Was there a motel with a swimming pool that felt like a palace to you as a child? What was the best part of finally stopping for the night?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

D-3

"Did your family ever camp out — in a tent, a camper, or even just sleeping under the stars in the back of the car? What sounds do you remember from those nights?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

The Destination

E-1

"What was the most memorable vacation destination your family ever drove to? What made it so special that you still think about it?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

E-2

"Did you ever visit a national park, the beach, the mountains, or a famous landmark? What was the first thing you saw that took your breath away?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

E-3

"What souvenirs did you bring home? Postcards, pennants, bumper stickers, a snow globe? Is there one you wish you still had?"

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

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SECTION 2

VISUAL SPARK CARDS

IMAGE-BASED CONVERSATION STARTERS — CUT, LAMINATE & SHARE

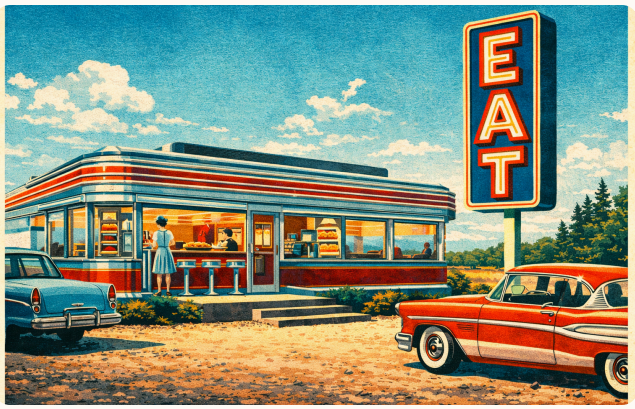
SPARK 1

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 2

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 3



✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 4

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 5

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 6

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 7

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 8

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 9

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

SPARK 10

✂ CUT & LAMINATE

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SECTION 3

TRIVIA TIME

20 QUESTIONS — CARS, HIGHWAYS & THE GREAT AMERICAN ROAD TRIP

The Cars We Drove (Questions 1–5)

1. What type of family car had wood paneling on the sides, a rear-facing back seat, and room for everyone's luggage?

Answer: Station wagon

2. Before GPS and smartphones, what large, folded paper item did the navigator unfold across their lap to figure out which roads to take?

Answer: A road map

3. What automobile club, known by three letters, provided trip planning booklets called 'TripTiks' and emergency roadside assistance?

Answer: AAA (American Automobile Association)

4. At a full-service gas station, the attendant would pump your gas, check your oil, and clean your what?

Answer: Windshield

5. What small, round-topped piece of luggage — often plaid or floral — did women use to carry toiletries and cosmetics on a trip?

Answer: A train case (or vanity case)

Roadside America (Questions 6–10)

6. What famous chain of roadside restaurants, known for its orange roof, was a popular family stop along the highway for decades?

Answer: Howard Johnson's

7. What series of small red signs along the highway used funny rhyming poems to advertise a brand of shaving cream?

Answer: Burma-Shave signs

8. What roadside chain, with a bright yellow sign and a name that sounds like a happy home, was famous for affordable rooms along the interstate?

Answer: Holiday Inn

9. What famous highway, sometimes called 'The Mother Road,' ran from Chicago to Santa Monica and became a symbol of the American road trip?

Answer: Route 66

10. What attraction in South Dakota features the carved faces of four U.S. presidents on the side of a mountain?

Answer: Mount Rushmore

Passing the Time (Questions 11–15)

11. In the license plate game, the goal was to spot plates from as many different what as possible?

Answer: States

12. What classic car game starts with one person saying 'I spy with my little eye, something that is...' and naming a color?

Answer: I Spy

13. Before portable music players, what small battery-powered device with a telescoping antenna let you listen to music and news in the car?

Answer: A transistor radio

14. What snack food, sold in a red-and-white striped box at gas stations, was a salty road trip favorite for generations?

Answer: Cracker Jack

15. What type of postcard — showing a motel, landmark, or sunset — did families buy and mail to relatives back home with a quick 'Wish you were here'?

Answer: A picture postcard (or souvenir postcard)

Famous Destinations (Questions 16–20)

16. What national park in Arizona is famous for its enormous, mile-deep canyon carved by the Colorado River?

Answer: Grand Canyon (National Park)

17. What national park in Wyoming is home to a famous geyser called 'Old Faithful' that erupts like clockwork?

Answer: Yellowstone (National Park)

18. What Florida theme park, built by a famous animator and opened in 1971, became one of the most popular family vacation destinations in the world?

Answer: Walt Disney World

19. What coastal highway in California, winding along dramatic ocean cliffs, is considered one of the most scenic drives in America?

Answer: Pacific Coast Highway (Highway 1 / PCH)

20. What beach boardwalk destination in New Jersey was famous for its saltwater taffy, amusement rides, and the Steel Pier?

Answer: Atlantic City

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SECTION 4

WORD LINK GAME

FIND THE BRIDGE WORD

Read the two outside words aloud. Residents find the single "bridge word" that fits in the blank to complete a familiar compound word or phrase on BOTH sides.

#	LEFT WORD	BRIDGE WORD	RIGHT WORD
1	HIGH	_____	SIDE
2	ROAD	_____	WALK
3	SUN	_____	OUT
4	CAMP	_____	PLACE
5	SUIT	_____	WORK
6	MOTOR	_____	HOUSE
7	POST	_____	BOARD
8	LAND	_____	DOWN
9	SAND	_____	TENDER
10	OVER	_____	OUT
11	HORSE	_____	PACK
12	DRIVE	_____	DOOR
13	MOUNTAIN	_____	KICK
14	HOME	_____	NESS

#	LEFT WORD	BRIDGE WORD	RIGHT WORD
15	**PASS**	_____	**HOLE**

Answer Key

1. WAY	2. SIDE	3. BURN
4. FIRE	5. CASE	6. BOAT
7. CARD	8. MARK	9. BAR
10. LOOK	11. BACK	12. IN
13. SIDE	14. SICK	15. PORT

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The Are We There Yet Kit BINGO

Mark each square as it's called · Five in a row wins!

B	I	N	G	O
Flat Tire	License Plate Game	Scenic Overlook	Souvenir Shop	Campfire
Suitcase	Road Map	Bumper Sticker	National Park	Cooler
Sunglasses	Vacancy Sign	FREE SPACE	Postcard	Motel Pool
Ice Cream Cone	Turnpike Toll	Roadside Diner	Sleeping Bag	Rest Stop
Station Wagon	Backseat Driver	Travel Pillow	Picnic Table	Gravel Parking Lot

Print one copy per resident · Use coins, buttons, or markers to cover squares

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BINGO Facilitation Guide

BONUS ENGAGEMENT PROMPTS · FOR THE FACILITATOR ONLY

When someone calls “Station Wagon”

Did your family have a station wagon? Who rode in the way-back seat, and what was the longest trip you ever took in it?

When someone calls “Road Map”

Who was the navigator in your family? Did they have a talent for reading the map, or was there ever a famous wrong turn?

When someone calls “Roadside Diner”

Do you remember a diner you stopped at on a trip? What did you order, and was there anything special about the place — a jukebox, a spinning pie case, a friendly waitress?

When someone calls “National Park”

Did your family ever visit a national park? Which one, and what do you remember seeing or feeling when you first arrived?

When someone calls “Campfire”

Is there anything better than sitting around a campfire? Did you roast marshmallows, tell stories, or sing songs? What do you remember about the smell of the smoke?

When someone calls “Motel Pool”

After a long day on the road, did your family ever pull into a motel just because it had a pool? What was it like jumping into that cool water after hours in a hot car?

When someone calls “Souvenir Shop”

What was the best souvenir you ever brought home from a trip? A snow globe, a pennant, a little spoon? Did you collect anything special from the places you visited?

When someone calls “Ice Cream Cone”

Is there anything better than an ice cream cone on a hot travel day? Did your family have a favorite roadside stand, and what flavor did you always pick?

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SECTION 6

MUSICAL MEMORY

Part A: Finish the Lyric

Read the artist name and the beginning of the lyric. Residents complete the missing word or phrase.

Nat King Cole (1946)

Route 66

"Get your kicks on Route ___"

Answer: Sixty-Six

Willie Nelson (1980)

On the Road Again

"On the road again, I just can't wait to get on the road ___"

Answer: Again

The Mamas & the Papas (1965)

California Dreamin'

"All the leaves are brown and the sky is ___"

Answer: Gray

Roger Miller (1965)

King of the Road

"Trailers for sale or rent, rooms to let fifty ___"

Answer: Cents

John Denver (1971)

Take Me Home, Country Roads

"Country roads, take me home, to the place I ___"

Answer: Belong

The Beach Boys (1963)

Surfin' U.S.A.

"If everybody had an ocean, across the ___"

Answer: U.S.A.

Part B: Name That Road Trip Tune

Read the clue. Residents name the song.

B-1

"Steppenwolf's thundering 1968 rock anthem became the unofficial theme song for motorcycle road trips. It tells you to fire up your engine and go looking for adventure — or whatever comes your way."

Answer: "Born to Be Wild" (Steppenwolf, 1968)

B-2

"Chuck Berry told Beethoven to roll over and give the news in one hit — but in THIS classic, he's cruising with no particular place to go, just driving and having a good time."

Answer: "No Particular Place to Go" (Chuck Berry, 1964)

B-3

"The Allman Brothers Band released this 1973 Southern rock classic about a man who was born with wanderlust — always moving, never settling, trying to make a living and doing the best he can on the road."

Answer: "Ramblin' Man" (The Allman Brothers Band, 1973)

B-4

"This 1975 Bruce Springsteen anthem is about escaping a small town with the one you love — racing through the night in a car with the radio on, looking for the promised land."

Answer: "Born to Run" (Bruce Springsteen, 1975)

B-5

"Simon & Garfunkel sang about leaving home and counting the cars on the New Jersey Turnpike in this wistful 1968 song. They've all come to look for something."

Answer: "America" (Simon & Garfunkel, 1968)

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